

Leave Policy

TechNova Pvt. Ltd. — Internal Policy Document

Document Code	Version	Effective Date	Policy Owner
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Purpose and Scope

This policy defines the types of leave available to TechNova Pvt. Ltd. employees, entitlement levels, and the process for applying for and approving leave. It applies to all confirmed, full-time employees across all TechNova office locations in India. Interns and fixed-term contractors are covered by the leave terms in their individual contracts.

The Company leave year runs from 1 April to 31 March. Leave balances reset at the start of each leave year, subject to the carry-forward rules below.

Leave Types and Entitlement

Leave Type	Annual Entitlement	Key Conditions
Casual Leave (CL)	12 days	For short personal matters; can be taken with at least 1 day notice; max 3 consecutive days without manager approval for a longer break.
Earned / Privilege Leave (EL)	15 days	Accrued at 1.25 days per completed month; used for planned time off; apply at least 5 working days in advance where possible.
Sick Leave (SL)	8 days	For illness or medical appointments; a medical certificate is required for sick leave exceeding 2 consecutive days.
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	As per the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961, for the first two children; 12 weeks for the third child onward; apply at least 8 weeks before expected delivery.
Paternity Leave	15 days	For male employees on the birth or legal adoption of a child; to be availed within 3 months of the event.
Adoption Leave	12 weeks	For the primary caregiver on legal adoption of a child below 3 months of age.
Bereavement Leave	5 days	On the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, sibling).
Compensatory Off (Comp-off)	As accrued	Granted for approved work on a weekend or Company holiday; must be used within 60 days of accrual.

Casual Leave (CL)

CL is intended for short, often unplanned absences such as personal errands or minor illness. Employees accrue the full 12-day CL entitlement at the start of each leave year. CL does not carry forward to the next leave year and is not encashed on exit. Unused CL lapses on 31 March.

Earned Leave (EL)

EL is meant for planned vacations and longer personal time off. EL accrues monthly at 1.25 days (15 days / 12 months) and can be applied once accrued. Up to 10 unused EL days may be carried forward to the next leave year; any balance above this is auto-encashed at the March payroll cycle based on the employee's basic salary. On separation, unused EL (up to a maximum of 45 days) is encashed as part of the Full & Final settlement.

Sick Leave (SL)

SL may be used for the employee's own illness, medical appointments, or to care for an immediate family member during a medical emergency. SL does not carry forward and is not encashed. A scanned medical certificate must be uploaded on the HR Portal for sick leave of more than 2 consecutive working days. Frequent short-notice SL patterns may prompt a check-in with HR to see if additional support is needed.

Maternity, Paternity, and Adoption Leave

- Maternity Leave: 26 weeks of paid leave for up to two surviving children (8 weeks may be availed before the expected delivery date); 12 weeks for a third child. A medical certificate confirming the expected delivery date is required.
- Paternity Leave: 15 days of paid leave, available to be taken in one or two blocks within 3 months of the child's birth or legal adoption.
- Adoption Leave: 12 weeks of paid leave for the primary caregiver on legal adoption of a child under 3 months old.
- Employees returning from Maternity or Adoption Leave may request up to 4 weeks of Work From Home under the Work From Home Policy, subject to role suitability.
- Creche/nursing-break provisions are available at office locations as per applicable law; contact HR for details.

Bereavement Leave

Employees may take up to 5 consecutive calendar days of paid Bereavement Leave following the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, sibling, or parent-in-law). This leave should be applied for as soon as reasonably possible; HR may apply it retroactively on the employee's behalf if needed.

Compensatory Off

When an employee is required to work on a weekend, a declared Company holiday, or beyond a reasonable extension of normal hours on a specific approved assignment, the manager may approve a Compensatory Off. Comp-off must be pre-approved before the extra work, logged on the HR Portal within 5 working days of accrual, and used within 60 days, after which it lapses.

Leave Without Pay (LWP)

If an employee has exhausted all applicable leave balances and requires additional time off, they may request Leave Without Pay, subject to manager and HR approval. LWP beyond 30 consecutive days requires Function Head approval and may affect benefits continuity; HR will advise the employee of any impact before approval.

Special Leave Categories

Leave Type	Entitlement	Notes
Marriage Leave	3 days (once)	For an employee's own wedding; available once during employment at TechNova; apply at least 15 days in advance.
Examination Leave	Up to 5 days/year	For employees pursuing an approved higher-education or professional certification programme; proof of examination required.
Voluntary/Blood Donation Leave	1 day per instance	On the day of donation at a recognised blood bank or Company-organised camp; certificate to be uploaded.
Jury Duty / Legal Summons Leave	As required	Paid leave for mandatory court appearance or jury duty; summons copy to be shared with HR.

The Sandwich Rule

Where a declared public holiday or a weekly off falls between two days of approved leave, the intervening holiday/weekly-off is also counted as leave ("sandwich rule"), except where the leave type is Sick Leave supported by a medical certificate, or Bereavement Leave. This ensures leave accounting reflects the employee's actual continuous absence from work.

Leave Cancellation and Changes

Approved leave can be cancelled or rescheduled by the employee from the HR Portal before the leave start date, subject to manager re-approval. Once leave has commenced, changes should be discussed directly with the manager and updated on the Portal as soon as possible for accurate record-keeping.

Manager Responsibilities

- Review and act on leave requests within 2 working days to avoid blocking employee plans.

- Ensure adequate team coverage during high-leave periods (e.g., year-end) by planning ahead with the team.
- Apply leave policy consistently and avoid informally discouraging employees from using entitled leave.
- Flag unusual leave patterns (e.g., frequent Monday/Friday sick leave) to HR for a supportive check-in, not as an automatic disciplinary trigger.

Misuse of Leave

Leave benefits are provided in good faith. Submitting false information to obtain leave (such as a fabricated medical certificate) is a disciplinary matter and may result in action up to and including termination, in line with the Employee Handbook's conduct provisions.

Public Holidays

TechNova observes 10 declared public holidays each year, published on the HR Portal by December for the following calendar year, along with 2 floating holidays that employees may use on a date of their choice with manager approval. The holiday list may vary slightly by office location to reflect regional observances.

Leave Encashment: Worked Example

Earned Leave above the 10-day carry-forward cap is encashed automatically each March. For example, an employee with an EL balance of 14 days on 31 March carries forward 10 days and receives encashment for the remaining 4 days, calculated as: $(\text{Basic Salary} \div 30) \times \text{number of days encashed}$. On final separation, encashment follows the same per-day formula for the full unused EL balance, capped at 45 days.

Interaction with Work From Home

Leave and Work From Home are recorded separately on the HR Portal. An employee working from home is expected to be reasonably available during core hours and should not mark a WFH day as leave, or vice versa. Employees who are unwell on a scheduled WFH day should apply for Sick Leave rather than continue working, to protect their own wellbeing and give an accurate attendance record.

How to Apply for Leave

- Log the leave request on the HR Portal under "Leave → Apply", selecting leave type and dates.
- The request routes automatically to the employee's reporting manager for approval.
- Except for sick leave or emergencies, leave should be applied for at least 1 working day (CL) or 5 working days (EL) in advance.
- Managers are expected to respond to leave requests within 2 working days.
- Leave balances and history are visible at any time under "Leave → My Balance" on the HR Portal.

Unplanned / Emergency Leave

If an employee is unable to apply for leave in advance due to illness or an emergency, they should inform their manager by message or call before the start of the working day and regularise the leave application on the HR

Portal within 2 working days of returning to work.

Leave Approval Workflow

Requests follow a single-step approval by default: Employee submits on the HR Portal → System notifies the reporting manager → Manager approves, rejects, or requests changes → Employee is notified and the leave balance updates automatically. Requests for more than 10 consecutive EL days additionally route to HR for a coverage check before final approval.

Regional Variations

Core leave entitlements (CL, EL, SL, Maternity, Paternity, Bereavement) are uniform across all TechNova offices in India. Public holiday dates vary by office location as described above. Employees on international assignment or hired outside India follow the leave terms specified in their local addendum to the Employment Agreement, issued by HR.

Leave During Notice Period

Employees serving their notice period may take EL or CL with manager approval, provided it does not disrupt an agreed knowledge-transfer plan. Leave overlapping with the last 5 working days of the notice period generally requires HR sign-off in addition to manager approval.

Sample Public Holiday Calendar (Bangalore, illustrative)

Date	Holiday
26 Jan	Republic Day
Mar (date varies)	Ugadi
15 Aug	Independence Day
Sep (date varies)	Ganesh Chaturthi
2 Oct	Gandhi Jayanti
Oct/Nov (date varies)	Diwali (2 days)
25 Dec	Christmas
1 Jan	New Year's Day

The definitive, location-specific holiday list for the current calendar year is published on the HR Portal under "Leave → Holiday Calendar" and may differ slightly for the Hyderabad, Pune, and Chennai offices to reflect regional festivals.

Frequently Asked Questions

Question	Answer
How many CL and EL days do I get per year?	12 Casual Leave days and 15 Earned Leave days per leave year (1 April – 31 March), plus 8 Sick Leave days.
Can I check my current leave balance?	Yes, under "Leave → My Balance" on the HR Portal, updated in real time as leave is applied for and approved.
Does unused Casual Leave carry forward?	No. CL and SL lapse at the end of the leave year; up to 10 EL days may carry forward.
Who approves my leave?	Your direct reporting manager, as configured in the HR Portal org chart.

Contact and Escalation

For questions about leave balances, approvals stuck in the workflow, or exceptions to this policy, contact HR at hr@technova.example or raise a ticket via "Help → Ask HR" on the HR Portal. Escalations not resolved by the assigned HR representative within 5 working days may be raised with the HR Business Partner for the employee's function.

Document Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of Change
2.0	Apr 2022	Introduced floating holidays and comp-off time limit.
2.2	Apr 2024	Added Adoption Leave and Examination Leave categories.
2.4	Apr 2026	Updated EL carry-forward cap and encashment formula.